

“ AS A LAYMAN
I WOULD NOW
SAY ‘I THINK WE
HAVE IT’. ”

**Rolf Heuer, CERN Director
General**, announcing the discovery
of the Higgs boson, July 4, 2012

In September 2012, NASA published the **eXtreme Deep Field**, the most detailed image of deep space obtained to date (see 2004). Back on Mars, in February 2013, Curiosity had moved on to analyze subsurface rocks after drilling a 2.5 in (6.4 cm) hole in the Martian surface.

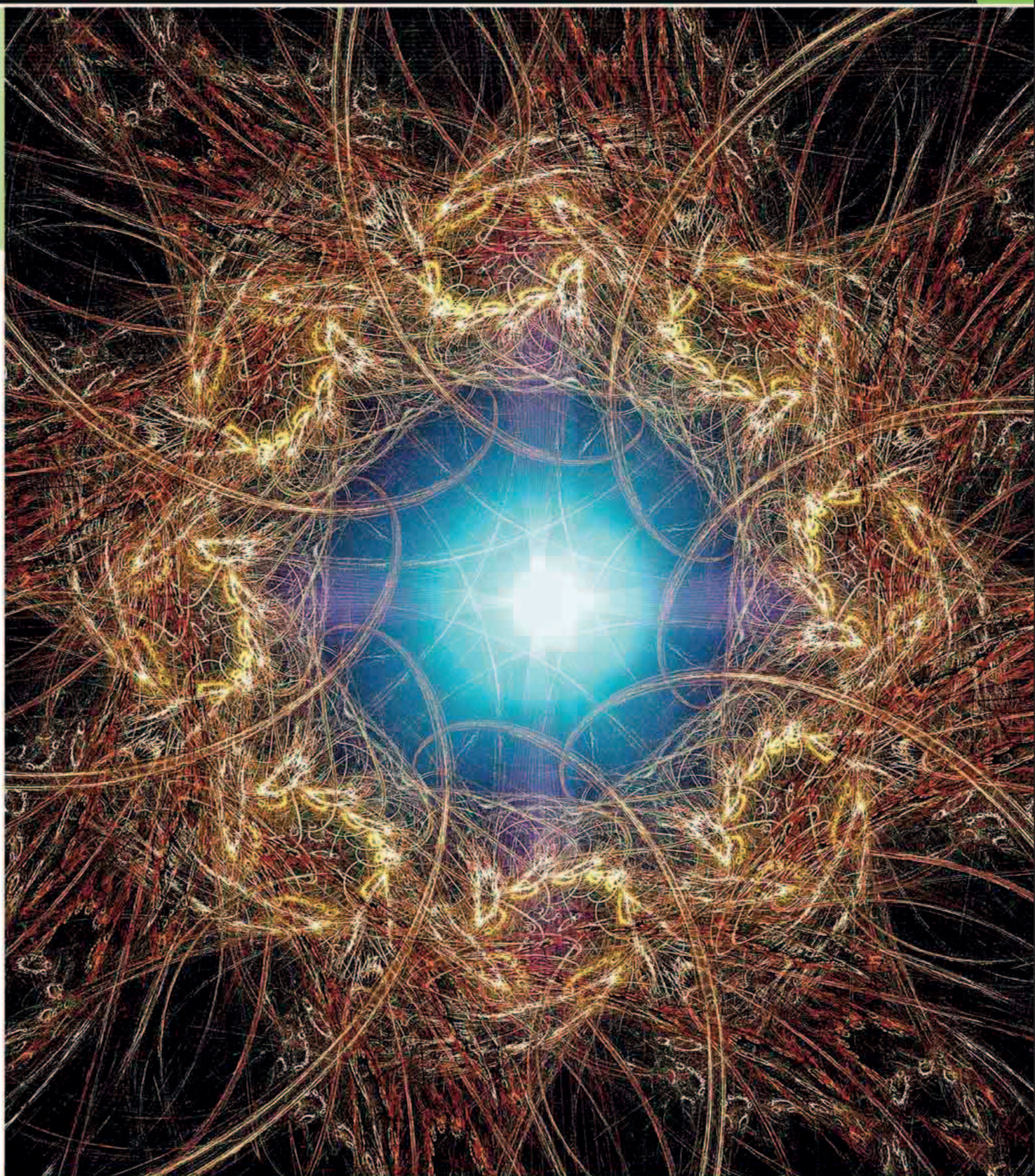
Regenerative medicine took two important steps forward in early 2013: scientists in the US successfully implanted a fully functioning laboratory-grown kidney into a rat, while a team in Bolivia **injected stem cells** into rats' brains soon after the rats had strokes and restored full brain function.

In China, a new strain of “bird flu” (see 1997), called H7N9, infected humans for the first time, causing concern of an epidemic.

Meanwhile, new calculations of the **age of the Universe** were being made. In March, data from the **European Space Agency's Planck satellite** refined cosmologists' estimate of the age of the Universe to 13.82 billion years old—about 100 million years older than previously thought.

Searching for the Higgs boson

This computer-generated image shows tracks from particle collisions inside the Large Hadron Collider. Analysis of such tracks provided evidence for the Higgs boson.



August 6, 2012 NASA's
Curiosity rover starts
sending images and data
from the surface of Mars

2013 New strain of
bird flu infects humans
for first time

February 2013
Curiosity rover
starts drilling 2.5 in-
(6.4 cm-) deep hole
in Martian surface

2013 Injected stem cells
restore brain function
in experiments on rats

September 25, 2012 NASA
publishes the Hubble Space
Telescope's eXtreme
Deep Field image

March 2013 New
estimate of age of
Universe announced
using data from
Planck satellite